

Publishing and Sharing in Tableau -

1. What is the key difference between publishing a dashboard on Tableau Public versus Tableau Server/Cloud in terms of accessibility and data security?

Tableau Public is a free platform where every published workbook becomes publicly accessible on the internet. Anyone can search, view, and download the workbook, making it unsuitable for confidential or business data. Tableau Server and Tableau Cloud are enterprise platforms that require user authentication and allow administrators to define permissions for individuals or groups. Sensitive dashboards remain protected because only authorized users can access them. Therefore, Tableau Public is best for portfolios and learning, whereas Tableau Server/Cloud is ideal for organizations handling private data.

2. When publishing a Tableau dashboard, what happens to a live connection compared to an extract? How does this affect data refresh and performance?

A live connection keeps the dashboard connected directly to the original data source. Every time a user opens or interacts with the dashboard, Tableau queries the source database and displays the latest available information. This ensures real-time data but may reduce performance if the database is slow. An extract creates a snapshot of the data stored in Tableau's optimized format. Extracts provide faster dashboard performance because queries run against the extract instead of the database. However, extracts must be refreshed manually or through scheduled refreshes to keep the data up to date.

3. In Tableau Server or Cloud, which feature allows administrators to control which users can view, interact with, or edit a published dashboard?

Administrators use the Permissions feature together with Users, Groups, Roles, and Projects. Permissions define whether users can view, download, interact with, edit, or publish content. By assigning users to groups and configuring project-level permissions, organizations ensure that only authorized people can access specific dashboards.

4. If you want users to view a dashboard but not download the underlying data, which permission setting would you adjust in Tableau Server?

Administrators should deny or disable the 'Download Full Data' and 'Download Summary Data' permissions for the required users or groups. This allows users to interact with

visualizations while preventing them from exporting or downloading the underlying dataset, thereby improving data security.

5. Name two methods by which a Tableau dashboard can be embedded into a web page or website.

Two common methods are: (1) Using the HTML Embed Code (iframe), which is the simplest way to display a dashboard inside a webpage. (2) Using the Tableau Embedding API (JavaScript API), which provides greater flexibility and allows developers to customize interactions, filters, events, and authentication.

6. List two best practices you should follow when preparing a dashboard for public sharing to ensure data security and privacy.

Before publishing, remove or anonymize confidential information such as customer names or financial records. Secondly, verify filters, hidden sheets, calculated fields, and permissions to ensure sensitive information cannot be accessed. Organizations should also implement Row-Level Security wherever required.

7. After publishing a dashboard, users report a 'Data not found' error. What is the most common cause related to data source settings?

The most common cause is that the published workbook cannot locate or access its original data source. This may happen because the file path has changed, database credentials are missing or expired, the server is offline, or the data source was not published correctly. Republishing the data source or updating the connection usually resolves the issue.

8. When embedding a Tableau dashboard into a secure internal portal, what two additional security measures should be implemented to ensure only authorized users can access the embedded content?

Use Single Sign-On (SSO) or SAML/OAuth authentication so users must verify their identity before accessing the dashboard. Also implement Tableau permissions together with Row-Level Security (RLS) so each user can only view the data they are authorized to access.